RSL · OFFICIAL RECEIPT
RASITI
M 9.99

Rasiti: receipts that reward

RSL Taxathon 2026 · Challenge 1: improving tax compliance in the informal sector

The problem

Many small traders in Lesotho sell every day but are not in the tax system. RSL cannot see who is trading or how much. For traders, registering and keeping records feels hard and gives nothing back. Customers rarely ask for receipts, so most sales leave no record.

Our answer: a receipt lottery

Rasiti is a **receipt lottery**. Every receipt is a **free ticket in a monthly prize draw**, so customers ask for one. Sellers join with just a name and phone, no tax number needed: every receipt builds them a **free sales book**, and they get a bonus when their customer wins. RSL gets a **live picture of real trade**. Brazil and Rwanda already use receipt lotteries.

"Rasiti" is the Sesotho word for receipt.

How the receipt lottery works: one example

More entries = a better chance, never a sure win. Amounts are examples.

1. Buy
Lerato buys M30 of snacks and a cold drink from Ntate Thabo at Sefika rank, and pays by M-Pesa.

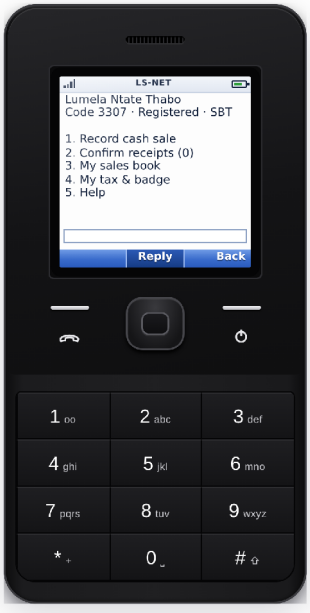
2. Receipt = ticket
Her receipt gives 3 entries (1 per M10). Thabo is registered for tax, so she gets **double: 6**.

3. Month-end draw
All the month's entries go in. The Fraud Shield removes cheats, then the computer picks winners at random.

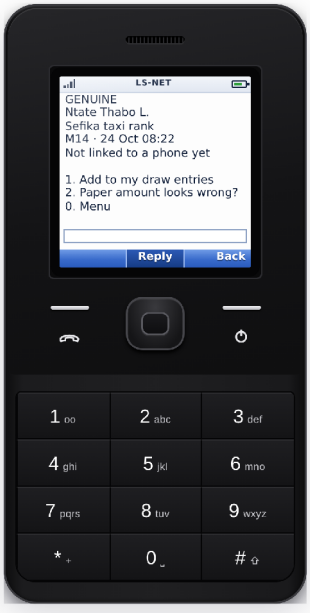
4. Both win
One of Lerato's 6 entries is picked, so she wins **M5,000**. Thabo gets a **M500** bonus for giving the receipt.

Each month: **1st** M5,000, seller M500 · **2nd** M2,000, seller M200 · **3rd** M1,000, seller M100 · **+20 winners** of M100 airtime

1 USSD: works on any phone



The seller's menu
Record a cash sale, confirm a customer's receipt, see the sales book, or register for tax.



A customer checks a receipt
Typing the code shows if it is genuine, who issued it and for how much.

NO SMARTPHONE NEEDED

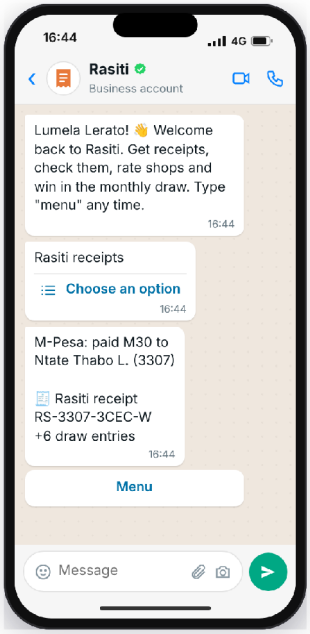
Most traders and many customers use basic phones. They dial one short code (for example ***999#**) and reply with numbers. No data, no app and no internet are needed.

A cash sale, step by step

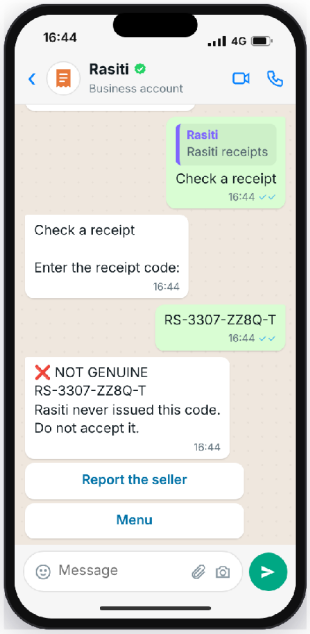
1. The customer pays cash and dials the code.
2. They type the seller's 4-digit code from the Rasiti sticker and the amount.
3. The seller confirms it on their phone.
4. The customer gets a receipt by SMS with their draw entries.

If there is no signal, the request waits on the phone and is sent when the signal returns.

2 WhatsApp: for people who prefer chat



Paying by mobile money
Paying with the seller's QR code issues the receipt and the draw entries automatically.



Catching a fake receipt
A made-up code is rejected at once, and the customer can report the seller with one tap.

SAME SERVICE, TWO CHANNELS

WhatsApp offers exactly what USSD does, with tap-to-choose buttons instead of typing numbers. People use whichever they like.

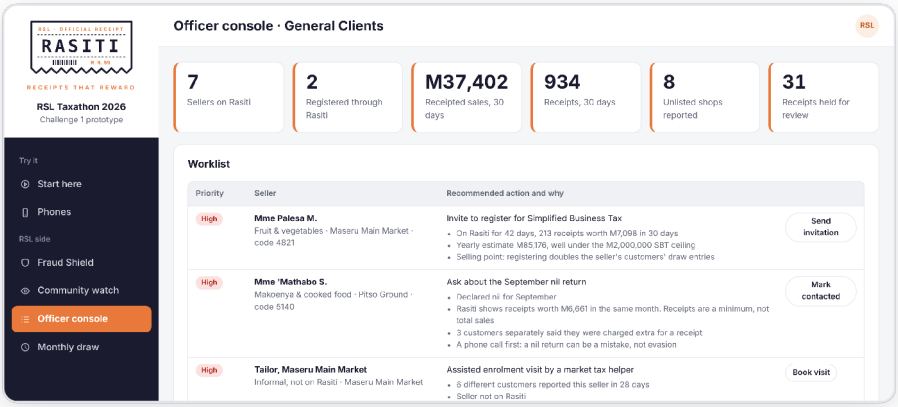
On WhatsApp a customer can also **share their location** when rating a shop, so RSL sees exactly where trade happens, and **find shops** that customers say always give receipts.

Customers can also rate a shop: "I got a receipt" or "No receipt given". Good shops earn a public **Gives receipts** badge.

Keeping it fair: the Fraud Shield

- Fake or changed receipt codes are rejected at once.
- Sellers buying from themselves, or one phone collecting many receipts, lose or pause their draw entries. The sales still count in the seller's book.
- Unusual cases go to an RSL officer. On test data it caught 61 of 65 planted cheats.

3 The RSL officer console



A private console with a **short worklist**, a satellite map, a review queue and the monthly draw. Every item says why it is there.

- **Invite** sellers whose sales show they fit Simplified Business Tax.
- **Call** when a nil return does not match receipts. A nil return alone is never wrongdoing.
- **Visit** stalls that 3 different customers reported.

Who pays for the prizes

Pilot prize pool: **M10,800 a month** (M8,000 prizes, M800 seller bonuses, M2,000 airtime), so **M32,400** for 3 months.

- **Sponsors first:** M-Pesa, EcoCash and the networks gain QR payments and branding, so they fund prizes. Wholesalers and banks can join.
- **Then self-funding:** a capped share (for example 5%) of the **extra** tax from sellers who registered or declared more. It never costs more than it brings in.
- **To start:** RSL's taxpayer education budget, until sponsors sign.

Proposed pilot

- **Where:** one Maseru market, compared with a similar one
- **How long:** 3 months, with 3 monthly draws
- **We measure:** new registrations, receipts given, declared sales against RSL's baseline, and extra tax against the M32,400 prize cost
- **Needs:** USSD code and WhatsApp number, M-Pesa and EcoCash links, approval to run a prize draw, Data Protection Act 2011 compliance

Try the working demo

USSD and WhatsApp phones, Fraud Shield, community map, officer worklist and monthly draw. All data is made up.

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